

Melissa Lee

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Experience

Pinterest — Software Engineer II

San Francisco, CA | Sept 2024 — Present

- Owned the time-critical production rollout of Pinterest's first context-aware safety filter across Homefeed, Search, and related surfaces, reducing filtration errors by 56% (8.7% to 3.86%) for minors and new users.
- Resolved launch bottlenecks for 15+ ML engineers by building an extensible real-time experimentation framework, cutting launch time from 7+ days to 2–3 days across 9+ experiments.
- Drove framework adoption across four partner teams as Content Quality's experimentation SME, delivering hands-on demos, writing end-to-end integration runbooks, and diagnosing production issues.
- Identified a five-day validation bottleneck and independently built a staging diff tool that compared control and enabled outputs across 56 locales in under 10 minutes, catching configuration errors before production.
- Built serving infrastructure and APIs to migrate core content ranking from batch pipelines to online inference, cutting data staleness from 2–3 days to one day and user preference update latency from days to hours.
- Launched an ML shoppability signal for 600M+ monthly users, lifting shopping pin impressions 55% and repins 47%.

Riot Games — Software Engineer Intern

Santa Monica, CA | June 2023 — Sept 2023

- Built and deployed a matchmaking simulation framework adopted by 5+ game teams, combining synthetic and recent live-match data to better represent live matchmaking conditions and cut algorithm iteration time by 30–35%.
- Identified anomalous player behavior in 18%+ of matches and filtered affected data to prevent biased matchmaking evaluations.

Riot Games — Software Engineer Intern

Santa Monica, CA | June 2022 — Sept 2022

- Built a real-time name-safety system deployed across all Riot titles, combining parallel evaluators with a BERT classifier to improve offensive-name detection by 50%.
- Designed a parallel evaluation framework that let game teams add classifiers without modifying the serving pipeline.

Pareto — Software Engineer Intern

Colorado Springs, CO | June 2021 — Sept 2021

- Built customer-facing React experiences and a workforce-management tool for 12+ users, cutting scheduling work by 3+ hours per week.

Education

Stanford University — B.S. in Computer Science, AI Concentration

June 2024

- GPA: 4.00/4.00 | Honors: Tau Beta Pi Engineering Honor Society

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, TypeScript, Java, C++, Go, Scala, SQL

Systems & ML: API design, distributed systems, online inference, low-latency serving, ML ranking and safety systems

Platforms & Tools: Docker, Kafka, Spark, Airflow, React

Leadership & Community

"Yes We Can" Wrestling Initiative — Founder and Mentor

- Won silver representing Team USA at the 2018 Pan-American Wrestling Championships in Guatemala City, Guatemala.
- Founded and led a four-school wrestling mentorship program serving 90 students, increasing female participation in the local elementary-school league by 60%.